



this integration: “Our responsibility is to translate commercial intent into product that truly reflects market demand, while remaining executable at the required quality, cost, and margin. This goes beyond coordination which requires disciplined, ongoing alignment across design, sales, costing, and production at every stage of development. Throughout this integrated approach, we can anticipate challenges early, make informed trade-off decisions, and maintain control over both value and execution. This is how Epic’s model drives competitive advantage by combining speed, transparency, and end-to-end accountability.”

Epic’s approach suggests the next phase of competitiveness may hinge as much on design capability, data-driven decisions, environmental performance, and customer integration. The replenishment model is a case in point. By redesigning how inventory sits across the factory floor, in transit, and at customer locations, Epic helped reduce the need for traditional distribution centers. Today, replenishment accounts for more than 60 percent of the business and has evolved to include US warehousing, pick-and-pack, and direct-to-consumer operations.

Epic’s Bhubaneswar facility is, then, more than a plant. It is a test case. Backed by around US\$100 million over 40 acres and designed for about 20 million garments annually, the campus is India’s first fully net-zero carbon and net-zero water garment manufacturing facility. The site integrates onsite and offsite solar, sustainable biomass, battery storage, energy-efficient systems, water conservation and recycling, super-insulated buildings, and biodiverse green space. These are not mere embellishments; they have direct business

implications: lower resource intensity, greater resilience, stronger customer credibility, and a more future-proof manufacturing model.

A standout innovation lies in the laundry system. In November 2025, Epic disclosed that the Bhubaneswar hub would use the world’s first high-temperature electric heat pumps to power an industrial laundry, supported by onsite and offsite solar systems and battery storage. The technology can generate hot water at around 135°C for industrial applications, while also producing cooling as a by-product to improve comfort for workers in the laundry during extreme heat. In other words, the design is about decarbonisation, as well as process efficiency and worker welfare.

Epic’s internal term for this is the “Epic Effect,” which is primarily a structural way of organizing the business around customer-aligned divisions with clear lines of accountability. But it is also linked to multiple organizational and business factors, such as connecting the working environment of the people making the product with the quality and consistency of the product itself. Seen narrowly, it might seem like an enlightened worker-welfare choice. Seen strategically, it forms part of a broader effort to build a differentiated operating system.

Taniya Nandi, Vice President of Human Resources in Bangladesh reflects on how this culture developed: “What makes Epic different is that care for workers isn’t treated as a separate CSR initiative—it’s embedded in how we design facilities, manage operations, and measure success. In Bangladesh, we’ve built a culture where people feel valued, and that translates directly into quality, retention, and pride in the work. That same philosophy is now being brought to India.”

Bhubaneswar is not being built as a standalone manufacturing site. Rather, Epic aims to create an Indian platform that can combine productivity, worker environment, customer satisfaction, quality, design sensibility, and long-term local relevance.

This is where the people-centric dimension becomes more than rhetoric. Depending on the speed of scaling, which will be achieved, the campus is expected to create around 7,000 to 10,000 jobs in the next few years, with women accounting for more than 80 percent of the workforce. That scale matters in Odisha, but the more interesting point is that Epic appears to be designing the factory around the idea that dignity, thermal comfort, cleaner infrastructure, and well-managed water and energy systems are not costs to be tolerated; they are essential to building world-class manufacturing. For Epic, sustainability has always been a core business discipline. In June 2024, the International Finance Corporation announced a US\$100 million financing package for Epic. Out of this, US\$70 million was offered as a sustainability-linked loan and US\$30 million as a green loan to support sustainable textile manufacturing in Bangladesh and India. The financing also supports Epic’s India expansion and investments in technology and equipment to reduce energy and water use. Importantly, the facility is tied to measurable sustainability targets, including reductions in greenhouse-gas intensity and freshwater intensity, and greater representation of women in management. For Hauke Otten, Chief Financial Officer, the message is clear: “sustainability at Epic is now embedded in capital allocation, process design, and operating metrics.” “When such renowned institutions back that direction,” he adds, it strengthens “both